Dial Tool

Guidebook
beta 4.36 · October 2026

A tool for drawing watch dials in a web browser. You describe a dial the way a watchmaker would think about it — a few rings of marks and numbers, three hands, a window or two — and it draws it at its true size, ready to print, etch or cut.

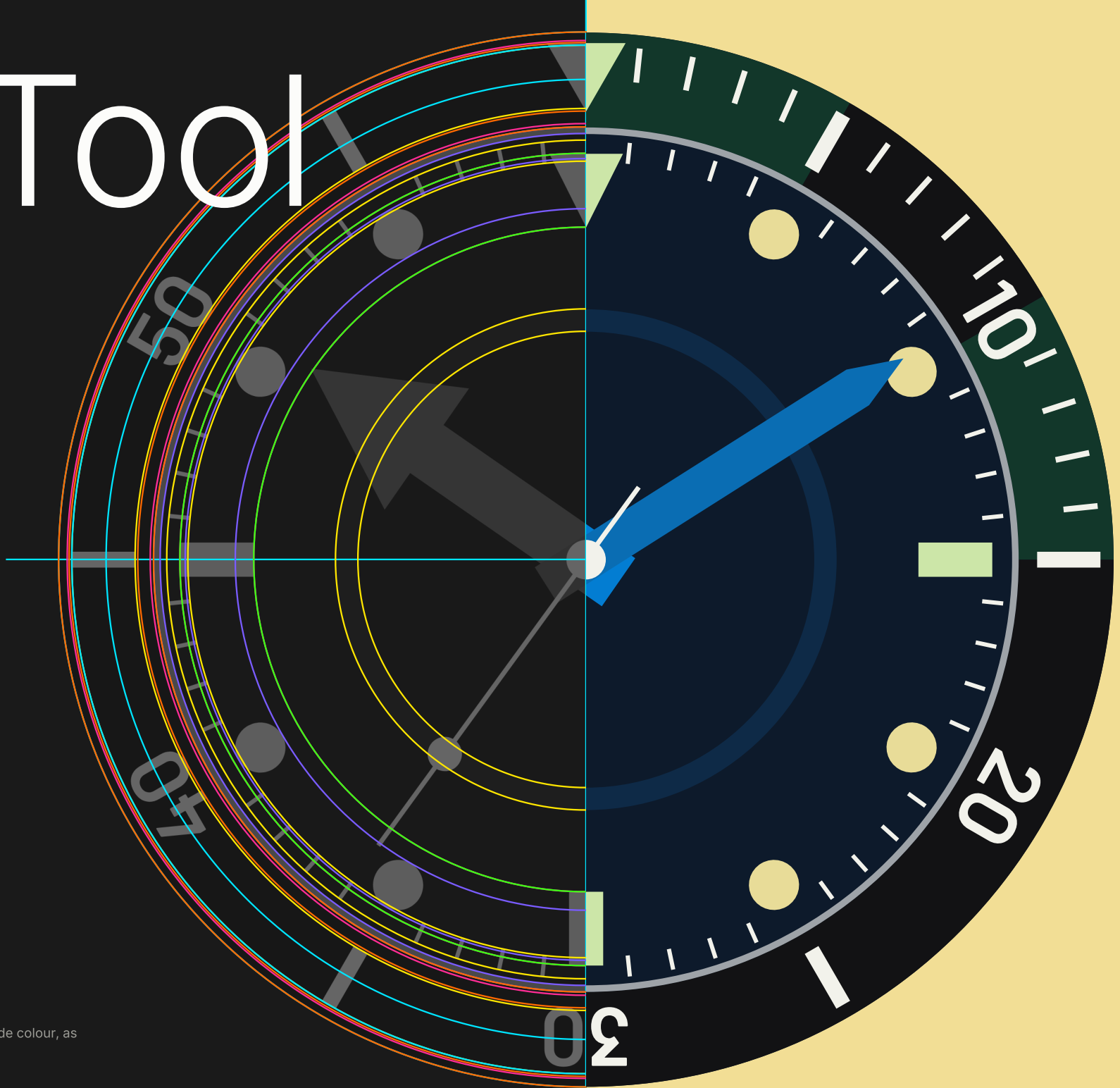
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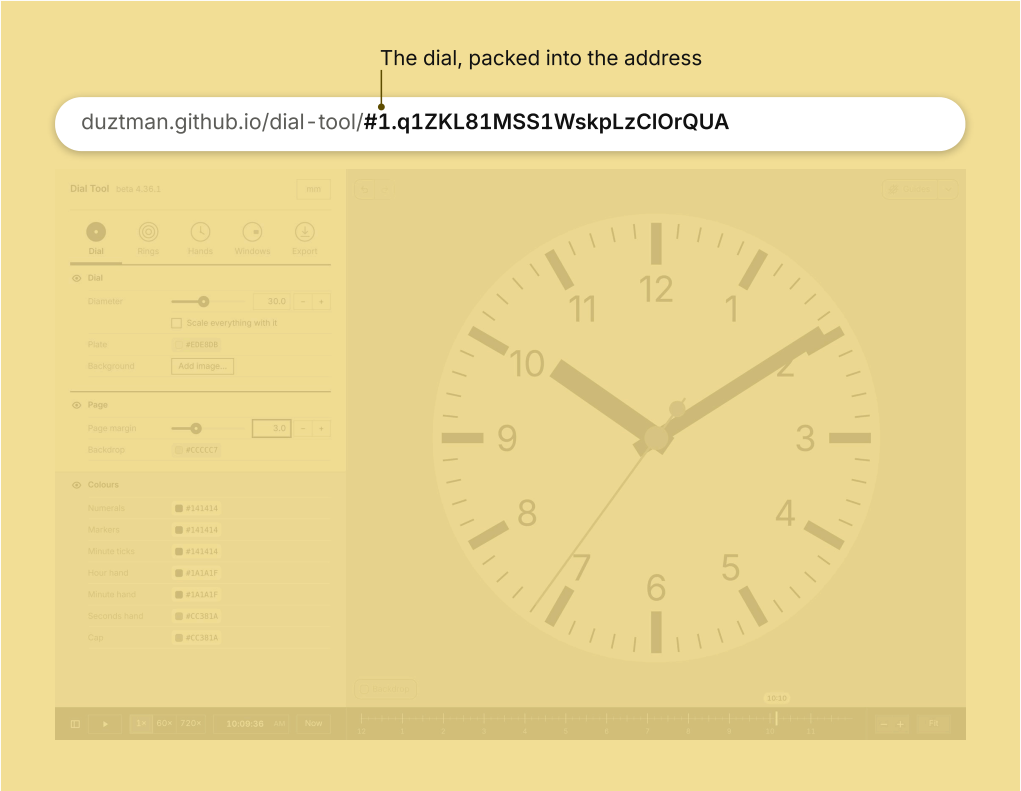
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Left, the dial as you build it: every ring's edges in its own guide colour, as the Guides view shows them. Right, the dial they make.

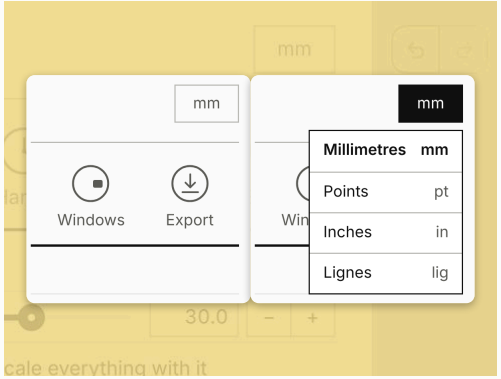
Start

Open the address and start drawing.
Nothing to install, nothing to sign up for.



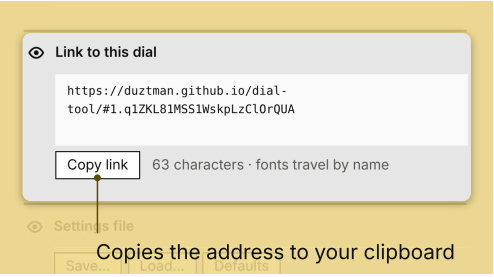
Where it lives. The tool is one web page: duztman.github.io/dial-tool. It runs in any current browser on a Mac or a PC, and on an iPad by finger. Chrome and Edge can also use the fonts installed on your computer.

The link is the dial. Everything after the # in the address is the dial itself, rewritten with every change you make. Bookmark the address to keep a dial; send it to give someone the same dial. No account, no file.

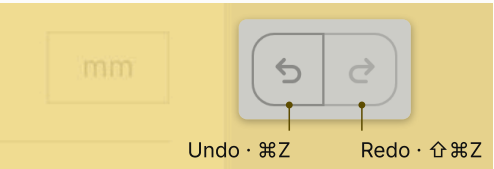


Everything is in millimetres. A dial is drawn at the size it will be on the wrist, often 28 to 40 mm across, and every length you type is a real length. The box at the top right of the panel changes the unit you read and type: millimetres, points, inches or lignes, the watchmaker's unit.

⚠ **Watch.** The unit box changes only what you read. The dial, its link and its files stay in millimetres.



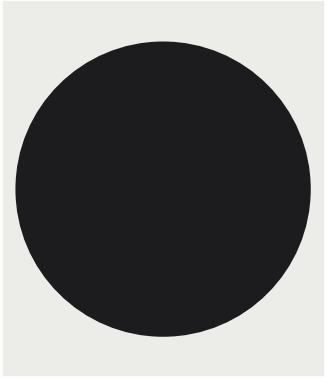
⚠ **Watch.** A link carries the dial, not its fonts. A font from your own computer reaches the other person only if they have it too; otherwise they see a stand-in.



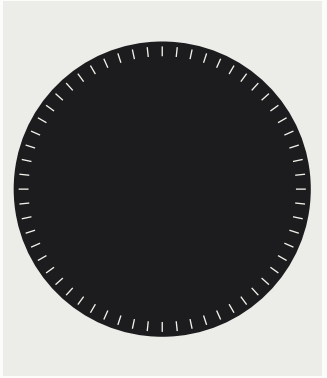
Changed your mind? Undo steps back through your changes, redo steps forward again; on a keyboard, ⌘Z and ⇧⌘Z. A step is taken each time you pause.

A first dial, in ten pictures

From an empty plate to a field watch in ten steps. Each picture is one change.



1 · The plate
Open the Dial tab. Set the diameter to 36 and pick a colour for the plate. This is the disc everything else sits on.



2 · The minute track
Open Rings and add a ring of ticks. Sixty short lines around the edge: this is the minute track every watch has.



3 · The hours
Add a ring of markers: twelve bars, longer and wider than the minute ticks, at the same distance from the centre.



4 · Let them make room
The minute ticks still run under the hour bars. Tell the ticks to **give way** to the markers and they step aside wherever a bar stands.



5 · The numbers
Add a ring of numerals. Twelve numbers, inside the markers. Move them in or out until they breathe.



6 · The font
Choose a font for the numerals from the list. You see every font as numbers, so you choose by eye, not by name.



7 · The hands
Open Hands. Pick a shape for the hour, minute and seconds hand, and make each one long enough to reach its own ring.



8 · A date
Open Windows and switch on the window at 3. A small opening appears with a date in it; type the one you want it to show.



9 · Colour
Give the seconds hand a colour of its own. One accent is usually enough.



dial.svg · 40 × 40 mm

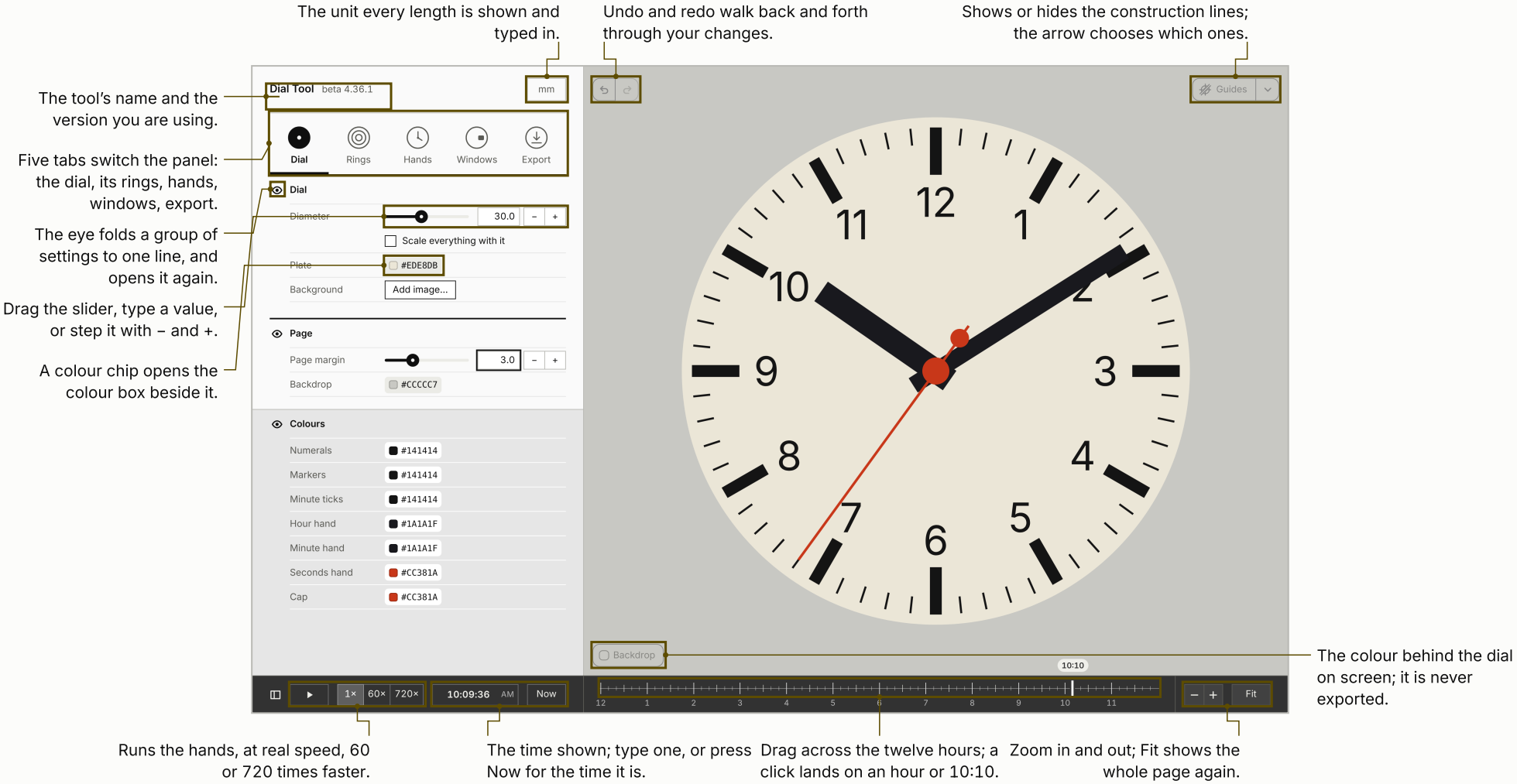
10 · Out
Open Export and save the dial as a PDF or SVG, drawn at its true size, or as a PNG picture. In an SVG the numerals can stay as editable text.



The finished dial. Open it in the tool and take it apart, ring by ring: every step above is still in it.

The whole window

Settings on the left, the dial on the right, the time along the bottom. Each part below is named for what it does.



Typing numbers. A number field also does small sums: +0.5 adds, x2 doubles, /3 takes a third. Useful when a drawing says "a third of the radius".

On an iPad. Everything works by finger. Small controls answer to a press a little outside their edge, and a number field grows larger while you touch it.

⚠ **Watch.** Guides and the backdrop are for the screen only. Nothing you see in them reaches an exported file.

The window

How to move around the tool.
The fastest way to a setting is often the dial itself.

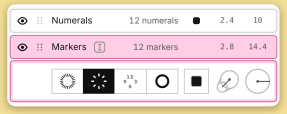




A numeral



A marker

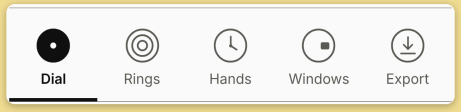


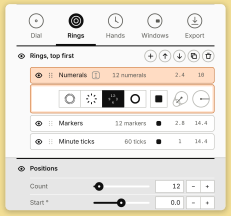
The click: Markers, in Rings

Point and click. Rest the pointer on any part of the dial and it is outlined, with its name beside it: a hand, a numeral, a marker. Click it and the panel opens that part's settings: the ring's row in Rings, the hand's own tab in Hands. A click on one numeral also picks that numeral for nudging.

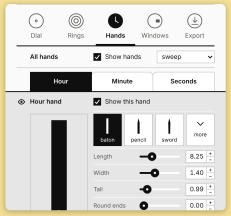
Moving around. Drag or scroll to move the dial; pinch, or hold ⌘ and scroll, to zoom. Up close, small parts are easier to point at. Fit brings the whole page back.

⚠ **Watch.** The outline and the name need a mouse. On an iPad there is no pointer to rest, so tap the part: its settings open all the same.



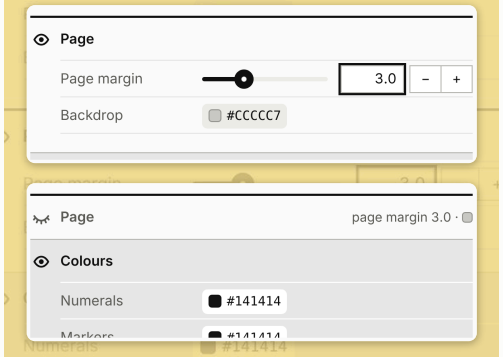


Rings

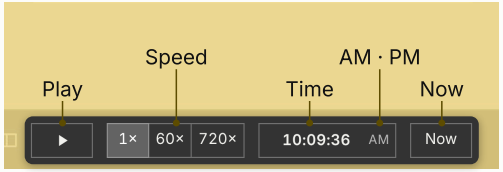


Hands

Five tabs. Dial holds the plate, the page and every colour. Rings holds the list of rings and the settings of the one you pick. Hands, Windows and Export hold what their names say. Most of the work happens in Rings.



Groups and the eye. Each tab's settings sit in groups under a thick line. The eye beside a group's name folds it to one line, which still shows its main values. Press the eye again to open it.



The bottom bar. The hands always show the time in the bar. Play runs them, at real speed or 60 or 720 times faster; type a time, or press Now. AM · PM turns the day over, so a window that shows it changes too.

Dial and page

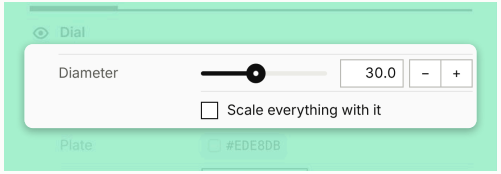
The plate, the page around it, and every colour on the dial.
The colour box is the same wherever a colour is chosen.

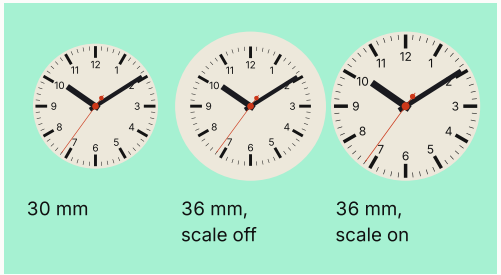


The colour box. A colour chip opens it. The top row repeats the colours already on this dial, so the same white is reused, not almost matched. The second row is your palette: ten to start, and + keeps the colour you have. Pick in the field and the hue strip below, or type a value. A ring's colour can also be see-through.

⚠ **Watch.** Your palette lives in your browser. It is not part of the dial, and a link does not carry it.

⚠ **Watch.** Only rings and band sectors can be see-through. A plate, hand or window colour is always solid.





Diameter. How wide the plate is, edge to edge. Every ring keeps its own distance from the centre, so a larger plate leaves the rings where they were, with more plate around them.

Scale everything with it. Tick it before changing the diameter and every measure on the dial grows or shrinks with the plate: rings, marks, numerals, hands, windows. The page margin stays as it is.

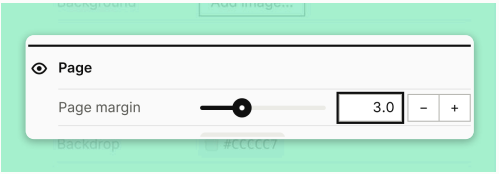
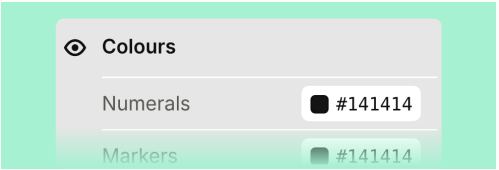


Plate. The colour of the dial itself; a dark plate needs light marks.

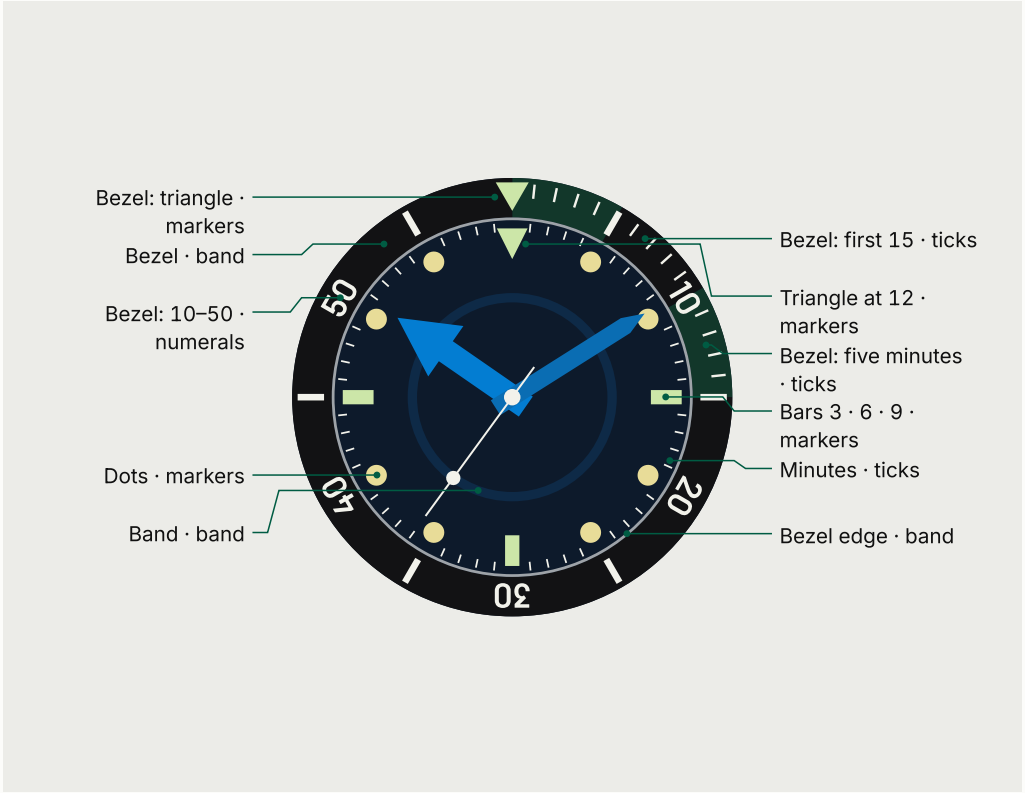
The page. An exported file is the dial on a square page with a margin around it. The backdrop is only what you see around the dial on screen.



Colours, all in one place. The Colours group lists every colour the dial uses: each ring, hand, the cap and each window, in one column. It is the quickest way to see and change the whole palette.

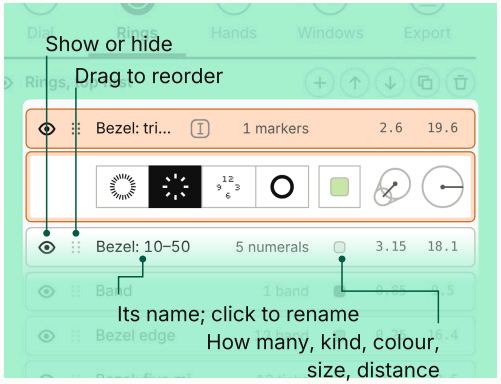
Rings

Every printed part of a dial is a ring.
A ring repeats one kind of thing round the centre.



What a ring is. One row in the list: one kind of thing, repeated at a set of positions, at one distance from the centre. Tracks, hour marks, numbers, rails, bezels and zones of colour are all rings. The diver here is eleven of them.

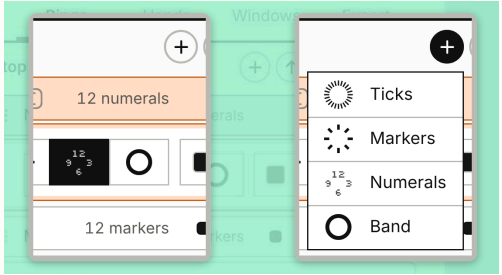
Four kinds. Ticks are lines, as on a minute track. Markers are heavier shapes, usually for the hours. Numerals are numbers or words. A band is a ring of flat colour, whole or in pieces. A ring's kind can change at any time; it keeps all its settings.



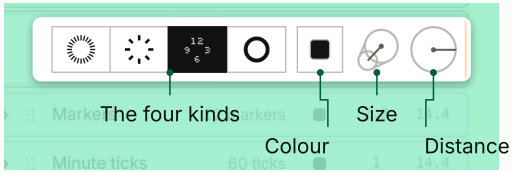
Top first. The list is the stacking order: the top ring is drawn last, over the others. Drag a row by its grip to move it.

A ring's row. The eye hides a ring without deleting it. After the name come how many and of what kind, its colour, its size and its distance from the centre.

⚠ **Watch.** A ring's distance is from the centre of the dial, not from its edge. Ticks and markers are measured to their outer end, numerals to their middle.



Adding and arranging. The + on the list's heading adds a ring of any of the four kinds. The arrows move the picked ring up or down, then duplicate and delete. A numerals ring can also copy the type of another, so two rings of numbers match.



The drawer. The ring you pick opens a drawer under its row: its kind, its colour, its size, its distance from the centre. Click a round button to type a value, or press and drag across it.